BigMarkt WebSocket — Bring Online Runbook

Audience: ops / on-call engineer **Last updated:** 2026-05-17 **Source code:** `websocket-server/` in the BigMarkt-Trade-Journal repo

---

Why this runbook exists

A recent launch-blocking audit closed a hole where the WebSocket server's `/status` endpoint was open to the internet and exposed live EA token IDs. After the fix (commit `18f5972`), `/status` is now a **trusted server-to-server channel** gated on a new `WS_STATUS_SECRET`. That changes the deploy story:

- The WS server now **refuses to serve `/status` with a `503`** if `WS_STATUS_SECRET` is unset.
- The journal's `getWsStatus()` returns `null` immediately if its own `WS_STATUS_SECRET` is unset, so the EA-setup page will show **"WebSocket server — offline"** even when Railway is running fine.
- "Online" now means **the secret is set in two places with the same value.**

This runbook walks through bringing the server back online end-to-end. Pre-existing deploy? Skip to step 2 and just add the new secret.

TL;DR

1. `openssl rand -base64 32` → save the string.
2. Paste it as `WS_STATUS_SECRET` on **Railway** AND on **Vercel** (Production + Preview).
3. Set `WS_STATUS_URL=https://<railway-url>/status` on Vercel.
4. Redeploy both services.
5. `curl -H "Authorization: Bearer <secret>" <railway-url>/status` → JSON.
6. Hard-refresh `journal.bigmarkt.co/ea-setup` → "WebSocket server — online".

---

1. Generate the shared secret (once)

```
openssl rand -base64 32
```

That's a single ~44-character string. **You'll paste the same value into Railway and Vercel.** Don't generate two different ones.

Save it somewhere shared (1Password, Doppler, team vault — wherever you keep the other env secrets).

---

2. Set environment variables on Railway (the WS server)

In **Railway → `websocket-server` service → Variables tab**, ensure all three are set:

Variable	Value	Where to get it
`SUPABASE_URL`	`https://awvrylniqppybwaiwzse.supabase.co`	Supabase dashboard → Project Settings → API
`SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY`	service-role JWT	Supabase dashboard → Project Settings → API → **service_role** (secret)

`WS_STATUS_SECRET`	the string you generated in step 1	Same value used on Vercel below

> ***Do not set `PORT` or `WS_PORT`*** *— Railway injects `PORT` automatically and the server reads `process.env.PORT` first.*

---

3. Deploy / redeploy Railway

First-time deploy:

1. Go to railway.app → **New Project** → **Deploy from GitHub repo**.
2. Select the `BigMarkt-Trade-Journal-` repository.
3. When asked for **Root Directory**, enter: `websocket-server`.
4. Railway reads `railway.json` from that directory and uses:
   - Build: `npm ci && npm run build`
   - Start: `npm run start`
5. Click **Deploy**.

Existing deploy:

Railway should redeploy automatically on the new push. If not, click **Redeploy** on the latest commit in the deployment list.

Watch the build log — `tsc` should produce no errors. The healthcheck hits `GET /healthz` and expects `200 ok`.

---

4. Grab the public WS URL

Once Railway shows the service as **Active**, copy the public URL from the dashboard. Something like:

```
https://bigmarkt-ws-server-production.up.railway.app
```

Keep it open — you'll need it in the next step.

---

5. Set environment variables on Vercel (the journal)

In **Vercel → `web` project → Settings → Environment Variables**, add (or update) the following on **Production AND Preview** environments:

Variable	Value
`WS_STATUS_URL`	`https://<your-railway-url>/status`
`WS_STATUS_SECRET`	**same value** as on Railway

Then trigger a Vercel redeploy:

- Either push an empty commit: `git commit --allow-empty -m "nudge" && git push`
- Or click **Redeploy** on the latest deployment in the dashboard.

The journal won't pick up new env vars without a fresh build.

---

6. Verify the WS server is reachable

From any machine (replace `<railway-url>` and `<secret>`):

```
# 1. Server is alive
curl -s https://<railway-url>/healthz
# expected: ok

# 2. Secret gate is enforced — no auth header should be rejected
curl -s https://<railway-url>/status
# expected: {"error":"Unauthorized"}

# 3. Authenticated request returns JSON
curl -s \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer <secret>" \
  https://<railway-url>/status
# expected:
{"connected_clients":0,"server_uptime_seconds":...,"ts":...,"connections":[]}
```

What each check proves:

- `/healthz` → Railway is running the right binary.
- Unauthed `/status` returning **401** → the secret gate works.
- Authed `/status` returning JSON → the secret on the WS server matches what you sent.

If any of these fails, see **Troubleshooting** below.

---

7. Verify end-to-end in the journal

Hard-refresh `journal.bigmarkt.co/ea-setup` (Cmd+Shift+R). The status card at the top should show one of:

- **"WebSocket server — online, no EA connected"** — server up, no EAs currently connected.
- **"WebSocket server — online · N EA connected"** — server up, N of *your own* tokens are active.

If you see **"WebSocket server — offline"**, the curl tests in step 6 will tell you whether it's a Railway or Vercel side issue. Most often it's a missing Vercel env var or a stale Vercel build.

---

8. Connect a real EA (end-to-end smoke test)

1. On `/ea-setup`, click **Generate token**, copy the token shown once.
2. In your MT4/MT5, open the BigMarkt EA inputs and paste the token into `ApiToken`.
3. Enable AutoTrading.
4. Within ~10 seconds, refresh `/ea-setup` — the status card should show your token connected with a "last ping Ns ago" timestamp.

The connection filter means **each user only sees their own tokens** in the connection list, even though the `/status` endpoint internally knows about every connected EA on the server.

Troubleshooting

`503 Status endpoint not configured`

The WS server is running but `WS_STATUS_SECRET` is missing from Railway. Set it (step 2), redeploy.

`401 Unauthorized` with the right secret

The secret on Railway and the secret being sent don't match. Common causes:

- Extra whitespace / newline pasted into one side.
- Vercel cached the old env value — redeploy after setting.
- You set it on Preview but not Production (or vice versa) — the deployment that's running uses the env from its environment.

`/status` works via curl, journal still says offline

100% a Vercel env issue. Confirm both `WS_STATUS_URL` and `WS_STATUS_SECRET` are set on the environment your current deploy is running in (Production), and that you've redeployed since setting them. `vercel env ls` in the project directory shows what's set.

`/healthz` returns 404 / connection error

Railway service isn't running. Check the Railway deploy log — typical failures:

- `npm ci` failure → version mismatch in `package-lock.json`. Re-run `npm install` locally and commit.
- `tsc` build failure → TypeScript error. Build locally to reproduce.
- Service crashes on start → check the runtime logs for the actual error.

EA connects but doesn't show on `/ea-setup`

- Confirm the EA token isn't revoked — it must appear in your token list on `/ea-setup`.
- Confirm the token belongs to *you*, not another user — the journal filters the WS server's connection list to the calling user's own tokens.
- Check the WS server logs in Railway for the EA's connection attempt and any auth failure.

Quick reference — env vars summary

Railway (`websocket-server` service):

```
SUPABASE_URL=https://awvrylniqppybwaiwzse.supabase.co
SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY=eyJ...
WS_STATUS_SECRET=<shared secret>
```

Vercel (`web` project, Production + Preview):

```
WS_STATUS_URL=https://<railway-url>/status
WS_STATUS_SECRET=<same shared secret>
```

Local dev (`web/.env.local`):

```
WS_STATUS_URL=http://localhost:8080/status
WS_STATUS_SECRET=<your local-dev secret, can differ from prod>
```

Why each piece exists

- **`SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY`** — the WS server validates incoming EA tokens against the database. Uses service role because EAs aren't authenticated Supabase users.
- **`WS_STATUS_SECRET`** — gates the `/status` endpoint so connection-state polling stays server-to-server.
- **`WS_STATUS_URL`** — tells the journal where to poll. Different per environment (Railway prod URL vs. localhost).
- **`PORT`** — Railway sets this automatically. The server listens on `process.env.PORT ?? WS_PORT ?? 8080`.

Where things live in the repo

File	Purpose
`websocket-server/src/server.ts`	Single HTTP server: `/status`, `/healthz`, and the WS upgrade endpoint
`websocket-server/.env.example`	Template for local dev `.env`
`websocket-server/railway.json`	Railway build + start command
`websocket-server/RAILWAY_DEPLOY.md`	Full deploy walkthrough (long form)
`web/app/(app)/ea-setup/page.tsx`	Journal-side fetcher + per-user filter
`web/.env.example`	Template documenting `WS_STATUS_URL` and `WS_STATUS_SECRET`

This runbook was authored alongside the launch-blocking-fix commit (`18f5972`) that introduced the `/status` secret gate. Future env changes should land here first, then propagate to `RAILWAY_DEPLOY.md` and the `.env.example` files.